

DEADPOOL & WOLVERINE: BOOK ONE - THE ANCHOR

Chapter 1: The Thermodynamics of Grief

The wind in North Dakota doesn't just blow; it hunts. It moves with a predatory intelligence, seeking out the weak points in your thermal protection like a raptor testing an electric fence.

I stood there, boots crunching on the permafrost. The sound was specific—a dry, brittle *crunch-snap* that vibrated up through the soles of my boots (custom orthotics, because saving the world wreaks havoc on your arches) and settled in my knees.

It was 4:00 AM. The witching hour for bad decisions.

The cold was a physical weight. It pressed against my suit, the bespoke red spandex that I had spent way too much of my remaining mercenary budget on. It was supposed to be thermally insulated. It was supposed to be "Arctic Ready." The guy who sold it to me—a cosplayer in Burbank named Dave who smelled of Cheetos and solder—had lied. Or maybe he just assumed I wouldn't actually go to the Arctic.

I could feel the cold seeping into my scars. The cancer under my skin didn't like the cold. It grew sluggish, angry. My healing factor was working overtime, burning calories like a furnace to keep my core temperature above hypothermic levels. I could feel it—a constant, low-level buzz of metabolic activity. It made me hungry. Not just "I could eat a snack" hungry, but "I would eat a raw elk" hungry.

I looked at the grave.

It was a humble thing. A pile of rocks. A crude wooden cross, tilted at a forty-five degree angle to form an 'X'.

Branding. Even in death, Logan stayed on brand. You have to respect the commitment.

Somewhere in the distance, The Platters were singing "Only You." It wasn't coming from a speaker. It wasn't coming from a car. It was coming from the narrative itself. The universe was providing a soundtrack to my breakdown. It was a nice touch. A little on the nose, maybe, but I appreciate the effort.

You know, I thought, staring at the frozen dirt. *For a long time, I wasn't sure I'd ever be back.*

The thought spiraled. It wasn't just a thought; it was a thesis statement on the state of modern media.

The Corporate Overlords—praise be to the Mouse, hallowed be His ears, long may He reign over the IP—had bought the Fox house. It was a hostile takeover. A merger of galactic proportions. Lawyers with briefcases made of human skin had descended upon the studio, redacting contracts, pruning timelines, canceling projects.

I had been in Purgatory. The Grey Zone. The place where franchises go to die, or worse, to wait for a streaming series on Hulu.

But then... they called.

The phone rang. The Bat-Phone. The Mouse-Phone.

They wanted me. Me. The Merc with the Mouth. The R-rated clown in a PG-13 circus. It was a mistake. It had to be. It was like inviting a raccoon to a tea party. Sure, he looks cute in the little vest, but eventually, he's going to bite the Duchess and steal the sugar bowl.

Marvel is so stupid.

I looked at the mug sitting on the rock. "I LIKE ME." The ceramic was frosted over. The coffee inside was a solid block of brown ice.

Look, Constant Nerd, I said to the wind. *I see you. I see you sitting there in your ergonomic gaming chair, scrolling through Reddit, typing furious essays about "Canon" and "Legacy." I know what you're thinking.*

I grabbed the shovel. The handle was wood. Ash, maybe. Or Hickory. It was cold.

You're thinking: "How? How can they do this? Logan died. He died on the tree. It was perfect. It was sad. It was art."

I lifted the shovel. It felt heavy.

And you're right. It was art. It was the only time this franchise ever accidentally made cinema.

I swung the shovel.

THUNK.

The ground didn't yield. It laughed. It was permafrost. It was concrete mixed with spite.

But here's the thing about art, I thought, raising the shovel again. *Art doesn't pay the bills. Sequels pay the bills. Merchandise pays the bills. Fortnite skins pay the bills.*

CLANG.

A spark flew. Actual fire from the friction of metal on frozen stone.

So we're going to do this. We're going to dig him up. We're going to desecrate the grave. We're going to un-bury the bury your gays trope, except it's a bury your mutant trope.

I dug.

It was rhythmic. Hypnotic.

Lift. Swing. Impact. Shock.

My hands blistered. My healing factor popped the blisters and grew new skin. Then that skin blistered. It was a cycle of microscopic violence.

I thought about Vanessa. I thought about the look on her face when I told her I was "just going out for milk." Milk in North Dakota. She knew I was lying. She always knows.

I thought about Peter. Dear, sweet Peter. He was probably at home, ironing his khakis, dreaming of a world where everyone just got along.

I dug deeper. The hole got darker. The smell changed. It went from "Clean Cold" to "Old Earth."

And then...

THUD.

Wood.

Hollow wood.

I stopped. I stood there, panting, my breath clouding the air in the grave. I was six feet down. The walls of the grave were frozen solid. I was in a box of my own making.

"Logan," I whispered.

I cleared the dirt from the lid. I used my hands. I tore my gloves. I broke a nail. It grew back instantly, which is actually really painful if you think about it.

I found the edge of the lid. I jammed the shovel blade into the gap. I leveraged it.

CREAK.

The nails groaned. They were old nails. Rusty. They gave up the ghost.

The lid popped open.

I shone my flashlight into the darkness.

And I screamed.

Not a fear scream. A frustration scream. A scream of existential disappointment.

It was bones.

Just bones.

Adamantium-laced bones, sure. They shone in the flashlight beam like chrome plating on a '57 Chevy. But there was no meat. No muscle. No scowling face. No sideburns.

Just a skull. Grinning. Mocking me.

"You lazy son of a bitch!" I yelled at the skeleton. "You rotted! You actually rotted!"

I grabbed the skull. It was heavy. Heavier than a normal skull. The metal added weight.

"How long does regeneration take?" I shook him. "Wake up! The studio needs you! The shareholders need you! I need you!"

Nothing. Just the rattle of teeth.

I threw the skull back into the box.

"AGHH MOTHER-FUCKER-- MY WORLD IS FUCKED!"

I climbed out of the grave. I grabbed the cross—the iconic X—and I smashed it. I channeled my inner Blackmore. I smashed it until my hands bled. I smashed it until the wood was splinters.

And then, the portal opened.

****Chapter 2: The Bureaucracy of Time****

The Time Door didn't just open; it unzipped reality.

It sounded like digitized velcro. *ZZZZZRP.*

An orange rectangle appeared in the air, hovering inches above the snow. It hummed. It radiated heat. It smelled of ozone and office supplies.

They stepped out.

The Minutemen.

They looked like riot cops designed by a minimalist architect. Black armor. Glowing orange batons. Helmets that obscured their faces, turning them into faceless agents of the state.

"Wade Winston Wilson," the lead agent said. His voice was amplified, metallic. "You are under arrest."

"For what?" I asked, wiping dirt from my mask. "Desecration of a corpse? Is that a federal crime? I feel like it's a misdemeanor in North Dakota."

"For crimes against the Sacred Timeline."

"Oh, that."

I looked at the skeleton. I looked at the Minutemen.

There were twelve of them. They had Pruning Sticks. One touch, and you're gone. Erased. Sent to the Void.

I didn't have my guns. I didn't have my katanas. I had... a skeleton.

"I'm not going back," I said.

"Resistance is futile," the agent said. "Wait, wrong franchise. Compliance is mandatory."

"I have a counter-offer," I said.

I jumped back into the grave.

"He's fleeing," one agent said. "Secure the perimeter."

They moved forward. Tactical. Professional. Boring.

I grabbed the legs of the skeleton. I pulled. The connective tissue snapped like dry twigs.

I leaped out of the hole.

"Surprise!"

I swung the legs. The adamantium shins hit the lead agent in the helmet.

CRACK.

It wasn't a clean sound. It was the sound of a pumpkin being hit by a baseball bat. The helmet caved in. The agent dropped.

The others opened fire.

I spun. I used the ribcage as a shield. The energy blasts hit the adamantium and scattered. *PEW. PEW. PEW.*

"It works!" I yelled. "Thanks, Wovie!"

I charged.

I was a whirlwind of bones. I stabbed a guy with a femur. I clubbed a guy with the pelvis. I used the skull as a bowling ball.

It was violent. It was messy. It was **Blackmore** level gore.

I ripped an arm off the skeleton. The claws were still retracted in the forearm housing.

"Snikt," I whispered.

I punched the mechanism. The claws popped. Three curved blades of shiny death.

I stabbed an agent in the chest. The claws went through the armor like it was paper. They went through the ribs. They went through the heart.

He gurgled. Pink froth bubbled on his lips.

"Sorry," I said. "That looks painful. Does it hurt? It looks like it hurts."

I pulled the claws out. A spray of arterial red painted the snow.

I spun. I slashed. I decapitated.

It was a dance. A ballet of blood and snow. And The Platters were still singing. *Only You.*

When it was over, I stood in the center of the carnage. The snow was red. The agents were dead. The skeleton was a pile of loose parts.

"Maximum Effort," I wheezed.

And then, I passed out.

Chapter 3: The 2018 Incident

Flashback.

March 14, 2018.

The day I tried to matter.

I was in the lobby of Stark Tower.

It was clean. Too clean. It smelled of lemon pledge and intimidation. The floor was marble. The ceiling was glass. The receptionist was a hologram.

I was wearing my interview suit. It was a Men's Warehouse special. "Buy one, get two free." It fit poorly. The shoulders were too big. The pants were too tight. I looked like a kid wearing his dad's court clothes.

"Mr. Wilson?"

I looked up.

Happy Hogan.

He wasn't happy. He looked like a man who was perpetually five minutes late for a meeting he didn't want to attend.

"Mr. Hogan," I said, standing up. I extended a hand. He stared at it like it was a dead fish.

"Follow me."

We walked to his office. It was a shrine to Tony Stark. Iron Man helmets on the shelves. Magazine covers on the walls. A picture of Tony and Happy shaking hands with the President.

I sat in the chair. It was leather. It squeaked.

"So," Happy said, opening my file. "Wade Wilson."

"That's me."

"Mercenary. Assassin. Mutant?"

"I prefer 'Mutate'. Or 'Enhanced'. Or 'God's Perfect Idiot'."

Happy didn't smile. He tapped the file.

"Why are you here, Wade?"

"I want to join the Avengers."

Happy stopped tapping. He looked at me. Really looked at me.

"The Avengers."

"Yes. Earth's Mightiest Heroes. I want in. I want to save the world. I want to be on the lunchbox."

"Wade," Happy sighed. "The Avengers isn't a club. It's not a pickup basketball team. We don't just hold tryouts."

"I have skills," I said, leaning forward. "I heal fast. I'm good with swords. I have a very high pain tolerance. And I'm great at marketing."

"Marketing?"

"Yeah. Social media. Tik Tok. I could be the 'Cool Avenger'."

Happy rubbed his temples. "We don't need a 'Cool Avenger'. We need responsible adults who can follow orders and not kill people in public."

"I can stop killing," I lied. "I can maim. I can injure. I can use non-lethal force. I can use harsh language."

"Wade," Happy said, closing the file. "You're not Avengers material."

The words hit me like a physical blow.

"What?"

"You're a lone wolf. You're chaotic. You're... you."

"I can change," I said. My voice cracked. "I can be better. I need this, Happy. I need to matter. Vanessa... she needs me to matter."

Happy stood up. The meeting was over.

"Go home, Wade. Aim for the middle. You'll be happier."

Aim for the middle.

Be average. Be mediocre. Be nothing.

I walked out of the tower. I took the elevator down. I walked past the hologram receptionist.

I went to the bathroom in the lobby. I looked in the mirror.

"Aim for the middle," I whispered.

I punched the mirror. It shattered.

Chapter 4: The Grind

Present Day (Pre-Abduction).

"Aim for the middle."

I looked at the poster in the breakroom. It showed a golfer hitting a ball down a fairway. It was inspirational. It was depressing.

I was selling cars.

Used cars. Certified pre-owned sadness.

My name tag said "Wade." Just Wade.

I adjusted my toupee. It was itchy. It was stapled to my head. Literally stapled. The pain kept me grounded. It reminded me that I was alive, even if I felt dead.

"Wade!"

My manager, Gary. He was a small man with a big voice.

"You have a customer on the lot."

"I'm on it, Gary."

I walked out. The sun was hot. The asphalt radiated heat waves.

A family. Mom, Dad, two kids. They were looking at a Kia Carnival.

"Hi folks!" I said, putting on my 'Salesman' face. It was a mask, just like the red one, but heavier.

"Looking for something practical?"

"We need space," the Dad said. He looked tired. He looked like Happy Hogan had told him to aim for the middle twenty years ago.

"The Carnival is perfect," I said. "It's an MPV. Multi-Purpose Vehicle. It's got sliding doors. It's got cup holders. It's got a vacuum cleaner built in. For the crumbs. And the souls."

"The souls?" the Mom asked.

"Just a joke," I said. "Sales humor."

I showed them the car. I pointed out the features. I talked about safety ratings. I talked about fuel economy.

I hated myself.

Every word was a betrayal. Every smile was a lie.

You used to be Deadpool, the voice said. *You used to cut heads off. Now you're talking about lumbar support.*

"We'll take it," the Dad said.

"Great," I said. "Let's go do the paperwork."

I sold the car. I made a commission. It was enough to pay rent. It was enough to buy medicine for Al.

It wasn't enough to matter.

Chapter 5: The Party

The apartment was small. It smelled of tacos and stale beer.

But tonight, it was full of love.

"Surprise!"

They jumped out. Dopinder. Al. Colossus. Negasonic. Yukio. Buck. Shatterstar. Peter.

And Vanessa.

My heart stopped. She was beautiful. She was glowing.

"Happy Birthday, Wade," she said.

I hugged her. It felt like home.

"You came," I said.

"Of course I came. We're friends, Wade."

Friends.

The word was a knife. A jagged, rusty knife.

"Right," I said. "Friends."

We mingled. I drank a beer. I ate a taco. I pretended to be happy.

"So," I said to Vanessa later, by the window. "Seeing anyone?"

"Actually, yes," she said. "His name is Dermot."

Dermot.

"He's a dermatologist?"

"No. That's his name. He's... nice. He's safe. He likes hiking."

"Hiking is good," I said. "Hiking is safe. No katanas in hiking."

"Wade," she said, touching my arm. "I'm happy. Are you?"

I looked at her. I looked at the party. I looked at my life.

"I'm trying," I said. "I'm aiming for the middle."

She smiled. It was a sad smile.

"Make a wish," she said, pointing to the cake.

I closed my eyes.

I wish I mattered.

I blew out the candles.

Knock. Knock. Knock.

The door.

I opened it.

The TVA.

"Wade Wilson?"

"Yes?"

"You're coming with us."

They grabbed me. They pulled me through a door of light.

And just like that, the middle was over. The end was beginning.

DEADPOOL & WOLVERINE: BOOK TWO - THE VOID

****Chapter 6: The Fall****

Falling is not like flying. Flying implies agency. Flying implies a destination. Falling is just gravity winning an argument with your mass.

I fell through the Prune-Space. It was a kaleidoscope of nausea. Colors that don't exist in the visible spectrum—octarine, fuligin, blergh—flashed past my retinas. I saw timelines branching and dying. I saw a universe where I was played by Danny DeVito (it was glorious). I saw a universe where Wolverine was a golden retriever.

Then, impact.

THUD.

I hit the ground. Hard.

My spine snapped. I felt it. The L4 and L5 vertebrae crunched together, fusing into a painful mass of bone spurs.

"Ow," I whispered into the dirt.

The dirt tasted of copper and old magic. It was grey, lifeless dust.

I pushed myself up. My back popped, re-aligning itself with a sickening *click*.

"Where the hell are we?"

I looked around.

It was a wasteland. A desert of grey sand under a purple, bruised sky. Ruined buildings jutted out of the ground like broken teeth. The Statue of Liberty (half-buried). The Golden Gate Bridge (twisted). The 20th Century Fox logo (a monument to corporate mergers).

"Welcome to the Void," I said to myself. "The trash can of the multiverse."

Logan was groaning nearby. He pushed himself up. He looked... bad. His suit was torn. His eyes were bloodshot.

"I'm gonna kill you," he said.

"Get in line."

****Chapter 7: The First Fight****

He lunged.

Blackmore Filter Activate.

It wasn't a fight. It was a butchery.

He hit me with the force of a freight train. His claws—six inches of indestructible metal—entered my abdomen.

SHLUCK.

I felt the cold steel slide between my ribs. I felt it puncture my lung. I coughed, spraying blood onto his face.

"Is that all you got?" I wheezed.

He roared. He headbutted me. His adamantium skull met my cancer-ridden skull.

CRACK.

My nose exploded. Cartilage and bone turned to mush. My eyes watered.

I laughed. I couldn't help it. It was absurd. It was beautiful.

I pulled a gun. My Desert Eagle.

BANG.

I shot him in the forehead. The bullet flattened against his skull, peeling back the skin in a flower of gore.

He stumbled back. The hole in his head started to knit together instantly. Steam rose from the wound.

"That tickles," he growled.

He slashed my legs. My femoral artery severed. Blood sprayed like a firehose.

I fell. He jumped on top of me. He stabbed me again. And again. In the chest. In the neck. In the face.

It was intimate. It was hateful. It was the most romantic thing that had ever happened to me.

"Enough!"

A voice.

We froze.

Engines.

A convoy appeared over the dune. Mad Max rejects. Vehicles made of scrap and hubris.

And leading them... Johnny Storm.

Chapter 8: The Human Torch

He looked good. Blue suit. Blonde hair. Swagger for days.

"Flame On!" he shouted.

He flew into the air. A comet of fire.

"It's him!" I yelled. "Captain America! Wait... no... FLAME ON!"

He threw a fireball.

And then... Pyro.

Pyro was sitting on a truck. He waved a hand. The fire just... died. Snuffed out like a candle in a vacuum.

Johnny fell. He hit the ground. *THUD.*

"Well," I said. "That was anti-climactic."

They captured us. They threw a bag over my head. It smelled of gasoline and fear.

****Chapter 9: The Fortress of Bone****

We were dragged into a giant skull. Specifically, the skull of Giant-Man. Because in the Void, subtlety is the first thing to get pruned.

Inside, it was a cathedral of bone. The marrow had dried out, leaving a honeycomb structure.

Cassandra Nova.

She sat on a throne. She was bald. She was British. She was terrifying.

"The loud one," she said, pointing at me. "And the sad one."

She brought Johnny forward.

"You talk too much," she told him.

And then... the skinning.

Blackmore Filter: Maximum.

She waved her hand.

Johnny's skin loosened. It was as if the glue holding him together dissolved.

He screamed. It started as a hero's yell, but devolved into a wet gurgle.

The skin slid off his hand like a wet glove. Then his arm. Then his face.

The muscle fibers were exposed. Red. Glistening. Twitching. The eyes, wide and lidless, stared in horror.

The pile of wet skin hit the floor with a *SPLAT.*

He collapsed. A heap of meat.

"Who's next?" she asked.

Logan popped his claws. "Me."

She laughed. She stuck her fingers into his brain.

****Chapter 10: The Odyssey****

We escaped. (Alioth ate a guard. It was messy. We ran).

We found a car. A Honda Odyssey.

"It's an MPV!" I shouted.

We drove across the wasteland.

The car smelled of spilled juice boxes and family arguments.

"Why do you care?" Logan asked.

"Because it's my world! My friends!"

"You're a joke."

"Say that again."

He did.

We fought in the car.

The Gore-Gasm.

It was claustrophobic violence. Two immortals in a minivan.

He stabbed me through the seat. The claw went through the upholstery, through my kidney, into the dash.

I smashed his head into the window. ***CRASH.***

Blood sprayed the GPS. It coated the hula girl on the dash.

We fought until we were exhausted. Until the sun went down.

"You're an idiot," he said, panting.

"I know."

We passed out. Wrapped in violence and Honda engineering.

DEADPOOL & WOLVERINE: BOOK THREE - THE RESISTANCE

****Chapter 11: The Bunker****

The bunker smelled of old leather, ozone, and defiance.

We woke up to find X-23 watching us. Laura. She looked intense. Sunglasses that reflected the desolation.

She took us to them. The Resistance.

Blade.

There's only one Blade. He stood in the shadows, sharpening a sword. *Shhhk. Shhhk.*

"Some motherfuckers always trying to ice skate uphill," he said.

"That's the line!" I cheered.

Gambit.

He was cooking gumbo. Void gumbo. Made from rat-rats.

"Woo, I'm bout to make a name for myself here," he said. His accent was thick enough to spread on toast.

Elektra.

She was cleaning her sai.

"Daredevil died," she said. "It didn't stick."

"It never does," I said.

****Chapter 12: The Plan****

We sat by the fire.

"We need to attack Cassandra," I said.

"Why?" Blade asked.

"Because she has a way out. And because it's the third act."

We made a plan. A stupid, suicide plan.

"Gambit, you charge things. Blade, you stab things. Elektra, you stab things. Logan and I... we jump."

Laura sat next to Logan.

"You're not him," he whispered.

"You're Wolverine," she said. "That's enough."

****Chapter 13: The Assault****

We stormed the base.

Gambit charged his cards. *BOOM.* Purple energy everywhere.

Blade was a whirlwind.

We sneaked in. We put the helmet on Cassandra.

"Now!"

We jumped.

Back to Earth-10005.

DEADPOOL & WOLVERINE: BOOK FOUR - THE WAR

****Chapter 14: The Corps****

One hundred Deadpools.

Lady Deadpool. Kidpool. Headpool.

"Maximum Effort," I whispered.

We charged.

It was a slaughter. A masterpiece.

I cut off a leg. Logan decapitated a variant.

We fought back to back.

"Peter!"

Peter arrived. The Corps stopped.

"Hi guys!"

****Chapter 15: The Ripper****

Paradox turned on the machine.

The world started to unravel.

"We have to bridge the circuit!"

We grabbed the cables.

The pain was ontological. My skin burned off. My atoms screamed.

"LOGAN!"

We held on.

The machine exploded.

****BOOK FIVE - THE END****

****Chapter 16: Shawarma****

We survived.

We ate shawarma.

"See you in the sequel," I said.

****THE END.****